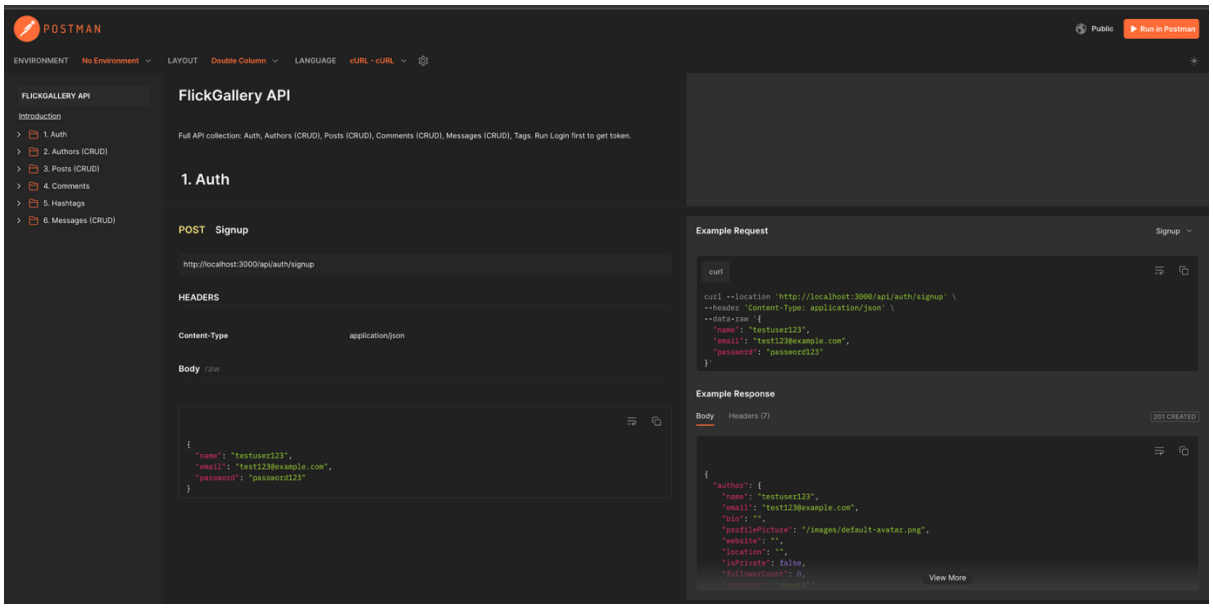
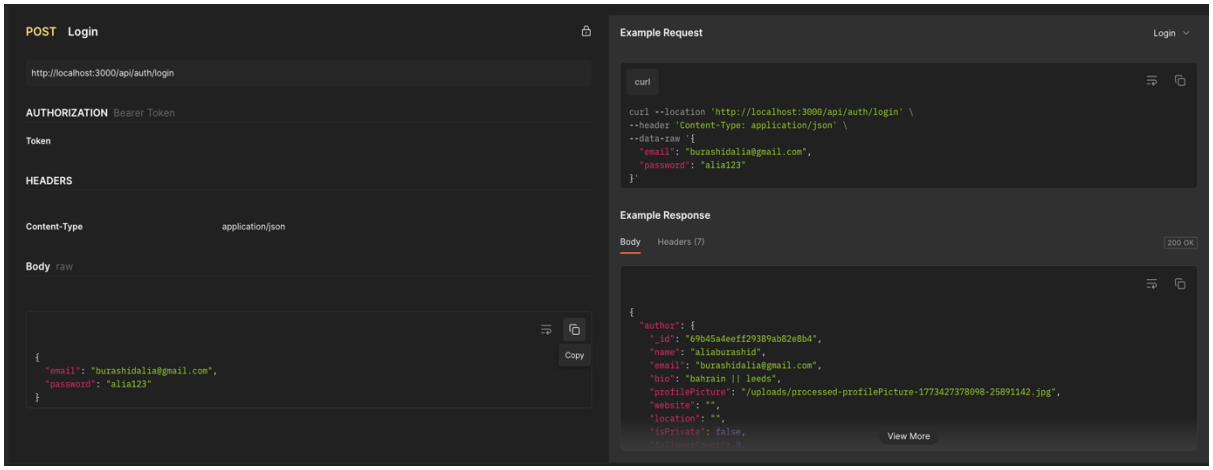
FlickGallery API Documentation:

Note: The screenshots in this document were captured manually. When printing Postman's published documentation, status codes and request/response bodies are not shown, so manual screenshots are used here to demonstrate the API. The URL: https://documenter.getpostman.com/view/47205615/2sBXihpXzV#313b6c27-19ec-4e43-b20f-81877bc74b03





POST Signup duplicate email → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/auth/signup

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "name": "testuser2",
  "email": "test@example.com",
  "password": "password123"
}
```

Example Request — Signup duplicate email → ...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/auth/signup' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data-raw '{
  "name": "testuser2",
  "email": "test@example.com",
  "password": "password123"
}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

json

```
{
  "message": "Email already exists"
}
```

POST Signup missing required field → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/auth/signup

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "name": "testuser",
  "email": "incomplete@example.com"
}
```

Example Request — Signup missing required fi...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/auth/signup' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data-raw '{
  "name": "testuser",
  "email": "incomplete@example.com"
}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Name, email, and password are required"
}
```

POST Login wrong password → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/auth/login

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "email": "test@example.com",
  "password": "wrongpassword"
}
```

Example Request — Login wrong password → ...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/auth/login' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data-raw '{
  "email": "test@example.com",
  "password": "wrongpassword"
}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid login credentials"
}
```

POST Login non-existent email → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/auth/login

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "email": "nonexistent@example.com",
  "password": "password123"
}
```

Example Request — Login non-existent email ...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/auth/login' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data-raw '{
  "email": "nonexistent@example.com",
  "password": "password123"
}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid login credentials"
}
```

GET Protected route without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/profile

Example Request — Protected route without t...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/profile'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

GET Protected route invalid token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/profile

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer invalid.token.here

Example Request — Protected route invalid to...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/profile' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer invalid.token.here'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "invalid token"
}
```

2. Authors (CRUD)

GET Get All Authors

http://localhost:3000/api/authors

Example Request — Get All Authors

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 200 OK

```
{
  "authors": [
    {
      "_id": "69b9ee638dfd9ed174d5d4e0",
      "name": "testuser123",
      "email": "test123@example.com",
      "bio": "",
      "profilePicture": "/images/default-avatar.png",
      "website": "",
      "location": "",
      "isPrivate": false,
```

View More

GET Get One Author

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/

Example Request — Get One Author

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 200 OK

```
{
  "author": {
    "_id": "69b9ee638dfd9ed174d5d4e0",
    "name": "testuser123",
    "email": "test123@example.com",
    "bio": "",
    "profilePicture": "/images/default-avatar.png",
    "website": "",
    "location": "",
```

GET Get One Author invalid id → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/invalid

Example Request — Get One Author invalid id ...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/invalid'
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid author id"
}
```

GET Get One Author not found → expect 404

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/507f1f77bcf86cd799439011

Example Request — Get One Author not found...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/507f1f77bcf86cd799439011'
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 404 NOT FOUND

```
{
  "message": "Author not found"
}
```

GET Get My Profile

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/profile

AUTHORIZATION Bearer Token

Token

HEADERS

Authorization

Example Request — Get My Profile

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/profile' \
--header 'Authorization:  '
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK

```
{
  "author": {
    "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
    "name": "aliaburashid",
    "email": "burashidalia@gmail.com",
    "bio": "bahrain || leeds",
    "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg",
    "website": "",
    "location": "",
    "isPrivate": false,
    "followerCount": 0,
```

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PUT Update Author

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/

AUTHORIZATION Bearer Token

Token

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
"bio": "bahrain || leeds"
}
```

Example Request — Update Author

curl

```
curl --location --request PUT 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{
"bio": "between bahrain || leeds"
}'
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK

```
{
  "author": {
    "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
    "name": "aliaburashid",
    "email": "burashidalia@gmail.com",
    "bio": "between bahrain || leeds",
    "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg",
    "website": "",
    "location": "",
    "isPrivate": false,
    "followerCount": 0,
```

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DELETE Delete Author

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Delete Author

curl

```
curl --location --request DELETE 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 403 FORBIDDEN

```
{
  "message": "Forbidden: you can only delete your own account"
}
```

POST Follow Author

http://localhost:3000/api/authors//follow

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Follow Author

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors//follow' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 200 OK

```
{
  "message": "You are now following shaymitchell",
  "followingCount": 3
}
```

POST Unfollow Author

http://localhost:3000/api/authors//unfollow

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Unfollow Author

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors//unfollow' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 200 OK

```
{
  "message": "You have unfollowed shaymitchell",
  "followingCount": 2
}
```

GET Get Author Posts

http://localhost:3000/api/authors//posts

Example Request — Get Author Posts

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors//posts'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 200 OK


```
{
  "posts": [
    {
      "_id": "69b7244b81a62a95cd5205d0",
      "author": {
        "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
        "name": "aliaburashid",
        "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
      },
      "caption": "My new post caption",
```


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GET Get Saved Posts

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/saved

AUTHORIZATION Bearer Token

Token

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Get Saved Posts

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/saved' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 200 OK


```
{
  "posts": [
    {
      "author": {
        "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
        "name": "aliaburashid",
        "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
      },
      "caption": "Sunsets hit different when you are truly present. 🌅",
      "imageUrl": "https://images.unsplash.com/photo-28034-b723cf961d3e?w=800",
```


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PUT Update Author without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"name": "Test", "bio": "Bio"}
```

Example Request — Update Author without to...

curl

```
curl --location --request PUT 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"name": "Test", "bio": "Bio"}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

GET Get Saved Posts without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/authors/saved

Example Request — Get Saved Posts without t...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/authors/saved'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

3. Posts (CRUD)

GET Get All Posts

http://localhost:3000/api/posts?page=1&limit=10

PARAMS

page	1
limit	10

Example Request — Get All Posts

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts?page=1&limit=10'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK

```
{
  "posts": [
    {
      "_id": "69b7244b81a62a95cd5205d0",
      "author": {
        "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
        "name": "aliaburashid",
        "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
      },
      "caption": "My new post caption",
```

View More

GET Get All Posts (page 2)

http://localhost:3000/api/posts?page=2&limit=5

PARAMS

page	2
limit	5

Example Request — Get All Posts (page 2)

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts?page=2&limit=5'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK

```
{
  "posts": [
    {
      "_id": "69b7266281a62a95cd520604",
      "author": {
        "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
        "name": "aliaburashid",
        "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
      },
      "caption": "My new post caption",
```

View More

GET Get One Post

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/

Example Request — Get One Post

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK

```
{
  "post": {
    "_id": "69b728a281a62a95cd520618",
    "author": {
      "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
      "name": "aliaburashid",
      "bio": "bahrain || leeds",
      "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg",
      "location": ""
    },
    "caption": "My new post caption",
```

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POST Create Post

http://localhost:3000/api/posts

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "caption": "My new post caption",
  "imageUrl": "https://images.unsplash.com/photo-1506905925346-21bda4d32df4",
  "hashtags": ["travel", "photo"]
}
```

Example Request — Create Post

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{
  "caption": "My new post caption",
  "imageUrl": "https://images.unsplash.com/photo-1506905925346-21bda4d32df4",
  "hashtags": ["travel", "photo"]
}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 201 CREATED

```
{
  "post": {
    "author": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
    "caption": "My new post caption",
    "imageUrl": "https://images.unsplash.com/photo-1506905925346-21bda4d32df4",
    "location": "",
    "likesCount": 0,
    "likedBy": [],
    "hashtags": [
      "travel",
```

View More

PUT Update Post

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "caption": "Updated caption",
  "imageUrl": "https://images.unsplash.com/photo-1506905925346-21bda4d32df4",
  "hashtags": ["updated", "edit"]
}
```

Example Request — Update Post

curl

```
curl --location --request PUT 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{
  "caption": "Updated caption",
  "imageUrl": "https://images.unsplash.com/photo-1506905925346-21bda4d32df4",
  "hashtags": ["updated", "edit"]
}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK

```
{
  "post": {
    "_id": "69b729c681a62a95cd52061c",
    "author": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
    "caption": "Updated caption",
    "imageUrl": "https://images.unsplash.com/photo-1506905925346-21bda4d32df4",
    "location": "",
    "likesCount": 0,
    "likedBy": [],
    "hashtags": [
```

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DELETE Delete Post

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Delete Post

curl

```
curl --location --request DELETE 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (4) 204 NO CONTENT

No response body

This request doesn't return any response body

POST Like Post

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//like

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Like Post

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//like' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK

```
{
  "likesCount": 1,
  "liked": true
}
```

POST Save/Unsave Post (toggle)

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//save

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Save/Unsave Post (toggle)

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//save' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK

```
{
  "saved": true
}
```

POST Create Post without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/posts

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"caption":"Test","imageUrl":"https://example.com/1.jpg","hashtags":["a"]}
```

Example Request — Create Post without token...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"caption":"Test","imageUrl":"https://example.com/1.jpg","hashtags":["a"]}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

POST Create Post missing caption → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/posts

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"imageUrl":"https://example.com/1.jpg","hashtags":[]}
```

Example Request — Create Post missing capti...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"imageUrl":"https://example.com/1.jpg","hashtags":[]}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Post validation failed: caption: Path `caption` is required."
}
```

GET Get One Post invalid id → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/invalid

Example Request — Get One Post invalid id → ...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/invalid'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid post id"
}
```

GET Get One Post not found → expect 404

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/507f1f77bcf86cd799439011

Example Request — Get One Post not found →...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/507f1f77bcf86cd799439011'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 404 NOT FOUND

```
{
  "message": "Post not found"
}
```

PUT Update Post without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"caption":"X"}
```

Example Request — Update Post without toke...

curl

```
curl --location --request PUT 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"caption":"X"}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

DELETE Delete Post without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/

Example Request — Delete Post without token...

curl

```
curl --location --request DELETE 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

POST Like Post without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//like

Example Request — Like Post without token →...

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//like'
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

POST Like Post invalid id → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/invalid/like

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Like Post invalid id → exp...

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/invalid/like' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid post id"
}
```

POST Save Post without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//save

Example Request — Save Post without token ...

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//save'
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

4. Comments

GET Get All Comments on Post

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments

AUTHORIZATION Bearer Token

Token

Example Request — Get All Comments on Post

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments'
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK

```
{
  "comments": [],
  "count": 0
}
```

POST Create Comment

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "content": "Great post!"
}
```

Example Request — Create Comment

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{
  "content": "Great post!"
}'
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (7) — 201 CREATED

```
{
  "comment": {
    "post": "69b7244b81a62a95cd5205d0",
    "author": {
      "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
      "name": "aliaburashid",
      "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
    },
    "content": "Great post!",
    "likesCount": 0,
    "id": "69b91d276d1d0ed176d5d511",
```

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DELETE Delete Comment

http://localhost:3000/api/comments/

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Delete Comment

curl

```
curl --location --request DELETE 'http://localhost:3000/api/comments/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response — Body | Headers (4) — 204 NO CONTENT

No response body
This request doesn't return any response body

POST Like Comment

http://localhost:3000/api/comments//like

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Like Comment

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/comments//like' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 200 OK

```
{
  "likesCount": 1
}
```

POST Create Comment without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"content":"Hi"}
```

Example Request — Create Comment without ...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"content":"Hi"}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

POST Create Comment missing content → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{}
```

Example Request — Create Comment missing ...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts//comments' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Comment validation failed: content: Path `content` is required."
}
```

POST Create Comment invalid post id → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/posts/invalid/comments

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"content":"Hi"}
```

Example Request — Create Comment invalid p...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/posts/invalid/comments' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"content":"Hi"}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid post id"
}
```

DELETE Delete Comment without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/comments/

Example Request — Delete Comment without t...

curl

```
curl --location --request DELETE 'http://localhost:3000/api/comments/'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

DELETE Delete Comment invalid id → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/comments/invalid

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Delete Comment invalid id...

curl

```
curl --location --request DELETE 'http://localhost:3000/api/comments/invalid' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) | 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid comment id"
}
```

POST Like Comment without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/comments//like

Example Request Like Comment without tok...

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/comments//like'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

POST Like Comment invalid id → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/comments/invalid/like

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request Like Comment invalid id ...

curl

```
curl --location --request POST 'http://localhost:3000/api/comments/invalid/like' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid comment id"
}
```

5. Hashtags

GET Get All Tags

http://localhost:3000/api/tags

Example Request Get All Tags

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/tags'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK

```
{
  "tags": [
    {
      "count": 123,
      "tag": "bollywood"
    },
    {
      "count": 54,
      "tag": "india"
    },
    {
```

View More

GET Get Posts by Tag

http://localhost:3000/api/tags/fashion

Example Request Get Posts by Tag

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/tags/fashion'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK

```
{
  "tag": "fashion",
  "count": 12,
  "posts": [
    {
      "_id": "69b590c7f7d0820b99b2342c",
      "author": {
        "_id": "69b14935b3251a75c634ac45",
        "name": "shaymitchell",
        "profilePicture": "/images/profiles/shaym
      },
```

View More

GET Get posts by tag - no posts (empty array)

http://localhost:3000/api/tags/nonexistenttag12345

Current behavior

- 200 OK with { tag, count: 0, posts: [] }
- Treated as: "valid search, zero results"

Example Request Get posts by tag - no post...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/tags/nonexistenttag12345'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK

```
{
  "tag": "nonexistenttag12345",
  "count": 0,
  "posts": []
}
```

GET Get posts by tag - unusual casing

http://localhost:3000/api/tags/FASHION

- Shows that the API handles tag casing (e.g. FASHION, fashion, Fashion) and normalizes to lowercase.

Example Request Get posts by tag - unusua...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/tags/FASHION'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK


```
{
  "tag": "fashion",
  "count": 12,
  "posts": [
    {
      "_id": "69b590c7f7d0820b99b2342c",
      "author": {
        "_id": "69b14935b3251a75c634ac45",
        "name": "shaymitchell",
        "profilePicture": "/images/profiles/shaym"
```


View More

6. Messages (CRUD)

POST Send Message

http://localhost:3000/api/messages

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{
  "recipientId": "",
  "content": "Hello from Postman!"
}
```

Example Request Send Message

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{
  "recipientId": "",
  "content": "Hello from Postman!"
}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 201 CREATED


```
{
  "message": {
    "sender": {
      "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
      "name": "aliaburashid",
      "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
    },
    "recipient": {
      "_id": "69b14908b3251a75c634aa50",
      "name": "zendaya",
```


View More

GET Get Inbox

http://localhost:3000/api/messages/inbox

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request Get Inbox

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages/inbox' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK


```
{
  "messages": [],
  "unreadCount": 0
}
```


GET Get Sent

http://localhost:3000/api/messages/sent

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request Get Sent

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages/sent' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) 200 OK


```
{
  "messages": [
    {
      "_id": "69ba01ba8dfd9ed174d5d559",
      "sender": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
      "recipient": {
        "_id": "69b14908b3251a75c634aa50",
        "name": "zendaya",
        "profilePicture": "/images/profiles/zendaya.jpg"
      },
```


View More

GET Get Conversation

http://localhost:3000/api/messages/conversation/

Returns all messages between you and another user (full DM thread)

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Get Conversation

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages/conversation/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK


```
{
  "messages": [
    {
      "_id": "69ba01ba8dfd9ed174d5d559",
      "sender": {
        "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
        "name": "aliaburashid",
        "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
      },
      "recipient": {
        "_id": "69b14908b3251a75c634aa50",
```


View More

GET Get One Message

http://localhost:3000/api/messages/

Returns a single message by ID

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Get One Message

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 200 OK


```
{
  "message": {
    "_id": "69ba01ba8dfd9ed174d5d559",
    "sender": {
      "_id": "69b45a4eeff29389ab82e8b4",
      "name": "aliaburashid",
      "profilePicture": "/uploads/processed-profilePicture-1773427378098-25891142.jpg"
    },
    "recipient": {
      "_id": "69b14908b3251a75c634aa50",
```


View More

PUT Mark Message as Read

http://localhost:3000/api/messages//read

Mark Message as Read can only be done by the recipient of the message (the person who received it), not the sender.

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Mark Message as Read

curl

```
curl --location --request PUT 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages//read' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 403 FORBIDDEN

```
{
  "message": "Forbidden: only the recipient can mark a message as read"
}
```

DELETE Delete Message

http://localhost:3000/api/messages/

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Delete Message

curl

```
curl --location --request DELETE 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages/' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (4) — 204 NO CONTENT

No response body

This request doesn't return any response body

POST Send message without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/messages

HEADERS

Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"recipientId":"","content":"Hi"}
```

Example Request — Send message without to...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"recipientId":"","content":"Hi"}'
```

Example Response

Body | Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```

POST Send message missing recipientId → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/messages

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"content":"Hi"}
```

Example Request — Send message missing re...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"content":"Hi"}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid or missing recipientId"
}
```

POST Send message missing content → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/messages

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"recipientId":""}
```

Example Request — Send message missing co...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"recipientId":""}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Message validation failed: content: Path `content` is required."
}
```

POST Send message invalid recipientId → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/messages

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer
Content-Type	application/json

Body raw

```
{"recipientId":"invalid","content":"Hi"}
```

Example Request — Send message invalid reci...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer ' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{"recipientId":"invalid","content":"Hi"}'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid or missing recipientId"
}
```

GET Get conversation invalid recipientId → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/messages/conversation/invalid

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Get conversation invalid r...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages/conversation/invalid' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid user id"
}
```

GET Get one message invalid id → expect 400

http://localhost:3000/api/messages/invalid

HEADERS

Authorization	Bearer

Example Request — Get one message invalid i...

curl

```
curl --location 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages/invalid' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer '
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 400 BAD REQUEST

```
{
  "message": "Invalid message id"
}
```

PUT Mark read without token → expect 401

http://localhost:3000/api/messages//read

Example Request — Mark read without token ...

curl

```
curl --location --request PUT 'http://localhost:3000/api/messages//read'
```

Example Response

Body Headers (7) — 401 UNAUTHORIZED

```
{
  "message": "Not authorized",
  "error": "Token missing"
}
```